

LIQUID

Beginner's Guide to Day Trading

Girls figuring out the market in real time.

No gurus. No BS. Just us.

Welcome to the community. This guide is everything we wished we had when we started.

Inside this guide you'll find:

- What day trading actually is
- Key terms you need to know
- An intro to futures trading
- Market sessions explained

- Popular strategies (ICT, order blocks & more)
- Platforms to get started on
- Honest advice on managing risk

01. What Is Day Trading?

Day trading is the practice of buying and selling financial assets — stocks, futures, forex, crypto — within the same trading day. The goal is to profit from short-term price movements rather than holding investments long term.

Unlike investing, where you buy and hold for years, day trading is active. You're in and out of trades sometimes within seconds or minutes. It requires focus, discipline, and a solid understanding of how markets move.

Only ~10% of day traders are consistently profitable. That's not to scare you — it's to prepare you. The ones who make it treat it like a business, not a game.

Why Do Most Traders Fail?

- They trade with emotion instead of a plan
- They risk too much on a single trade
- They skip learning the basics and chase quick money
- They give up after a few losses instead of treating it as a learning curve

02. Key Terms to Know

You'll see these terms constantly. Get comfortable with them early.

Term	Definition
Ticker / Symbol	The shorthand name for a traded asset. e.g. AAPL for Apple, NQ for Nasdaq futures.
Long	Buying an asset expecting the price to go up.
Short	Selling an asset expecting the price to go down. You profit when it drops.
Entry	The price at which you open a trade.
Exit / Target	The price at which you close the trade and take your profit.
Stop Loss (SL)	A pre-set price where your trade automatically closes to limit your loss.
Take Profit (TP)	A pre-set price where your trade automatically closes to lock in your gain.
Spread	The difference between the buy price and sell price. This is a cost of trading.
Leverage	Borrowing power that lets you control a larger position with less money. High risk - use carefully.
PnL	Profit and Loss. How much you made or lost on a trade.
Drawdown	How much your account has dropped from its peak. A risk management metric.
Liquidity	How easily an asset can be bought or sold without affecting its price. High liquidity = smoother trades.
Volatility	How much and how fast a price moves. High volatility = bigger opportunities and bigger risks.
Confluence	When multiple signals or indicators point to the same trade idea. More confluence = stronger setup.

03. What Are Futures?

Futures are contracts to buy or sell an asset at a set price on a future date. In day trading, most traders don't actually hold futures to expiration — they trade them for the price movement.

Futures are popular because they're highly liquid, trade almost 24 hours a day, and offer tax advantages compared to stocks in some cases.

Popular Futures Instruments

Symbol	What It Tracks	Size
NQ	Nasdaq 100 (tech stocks)	Full size — larger contract
MNQ	Nasdaq 100 (micro)	1/10th of NQ — great for beginners
ES	S&P 500	Full size — most traded futures
MES	S&P 500 (micro)	1/10th of ES — beginner friendly
GC	Gold	Gold futures
BTC	Bitcoin	Crypto futures

Start with MNQ or MES. They track the same markets as the big contracts but with much smaller risk per tick — perfect while you're learning.

04. Market Sessions

Markets don't move the same way all day. Understanding sessions helps you know when to trade and when to stay out.

Session	Time (EST)	What to Know
Asia Session	6:00 PM – 3:00 AM	Low volume, slow movement. Sets overnight range.
London Session	3:00 AM – 8:00 AM	High volatility. Major moves often start here.
New York Session	8:00 AM – 5:00 PM	Most volume. Best for day trading. NY open (9:30 AM) is key.
Pre-Market	4:00 AM – 9:30 AM	Futures active before stock market opens.
Power Hour	3:00 PM – 4:00 PM	Last hour of NYSE — often big moves.

Most day traders focus on the New York session, specifically the first 2 hours after the 9:30 AM open when volume and volatility are highest.

05. Popular Strategies

There is no single strategy that works for everyone. The goal is to find one that fits your schedule, personality, and risk tolerance — then master it before adding more.

ICT (Inner Circle Trader)

ICT is a methodology developed by Michael Huddleston. It focuses on how institutional traders (the "smart money") move the market. Key concepts include order blocks, fair value gaps, liquidity sweeps, and market structure. It's one of the most popular strategies in the retail trading community right now.

Order Flow

Order flow trading focuses on reading the actual buying and selling pressure in the market in real time. Rather than just looking at price, order flow traders analyze volume, bid/ask activity, and how orders are being absorbed to anticipate where price is likely to move next.

FVGs — Fair Value Gaps

A fair value gap is a gap in price action where the market moved so fast that it left an "imbalance." Price often comes back to fill these gaps. FVGs are a core part of ICT and smart money concepts.

Market Profile

Market profile uses volume and price to understand where the market spent the most time trading. It helps identify value areas, support and resistance, and potential reversal zones.

Swing Trading

Swing trading holds positions for days or weeks rather than minutes. It's less intense than day trading and can be a good starting point for beginners still learning to read the market.

Don't strategy hop. Pick one, learn it deeply, demo trade it, then go live. Switching strategies every week is one of the biggest reasons traders don't progress.

06. Platforms to Get Started

TradingView

Best for charting and analysis. Free tier is solid. Most traders use this to read charts regardless of where they execute trades.

Webull

Free stock and options trading. Great for beginners. Has paper trading (fake money practice mode).

Tastytrade

Popular for options and futures. Clean interface, good for active traders.

NinjaTrader

Preferred platform for futures traders. Free to use for charting and simulation.

Topstep / Apex

Funded account programs — you trade their money after passing an evaluation. Good goal to work toward.

Always paper trade (practice with fake money) before using real money. Most platforms have a simulation mode — use it.

07. Risk Management

This is the most important section in this entire guide. You can have the best strategy in the world and still blow your account without proper risk management.

Never risk more than 1-2% per trade

If you have a \$1,000 account, risk no more than \$10-\$20 per trade. This keeps you in the game long enough to learn.

Always use a stop loss

No exceptions. A stop loss is your safety net. Trading without one is gambling.

Define your risk before you enter

Know exactly how much you're willing to lose before you click buy or sell.

Don't revenge trade

If you take a loss, step away. Trading emotionally to "make it back" is how small losses become big ones.

Keep a trading journal

Write down every trade — entry, exit, why you took it, how you felt. Patterns in your behavior are often more valuable than patterns on the chart.

You Made It.

This is just the beginning. Day trading is a skill — it takes time, repetition, and a lot of patience with yourself. The girls who make it aren't the ones who never lose. They're the ones who keep showing up, keep learning, and refuse to quit.

Come ask questions, share your trades, and grow with us in the Liquid Discord. That's what we're here for. ■

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Day trading. For the girls.